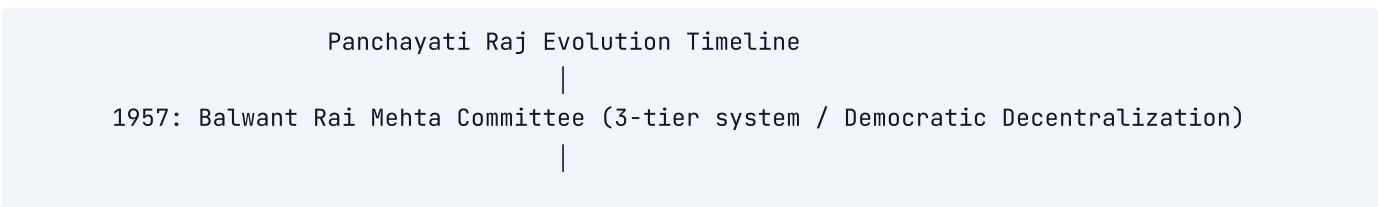
Topic 27 – Important Committees and Commissions (Fact-Lock)

> **Priority S** | Match-the-following on 4 random committees (Year / Subject / Recommendation) is a guaranteed recurring UPPCS/UKPCS pattern.
> **Pair with:** Panchayati Raj (पंचायती राज) · Centre-State Relations · Constitutional Bodies

1. Centre-State Relations & Governance

Committee / Commission	Year	Core Mandate & Key Recommendations
Rajamannar Committee	**1969**	Appointed by Tamil Nadu Government; recommended abolition of IAS/IPS, repeal of Art 356, and vestment of residual powers in States.
Sarkaria Commission	**1983–88**	Centre-State relations (Justice R. S. Sarkaria, B. Sivaraman, S. R. Sen); recommended strong Centre, Article 356 as an extraordinary last resort, and establishing permanent Inter-State Council (set up 1990 under Art 263).
Punchhi Commission	**2007–10**	Centre-State relations (Justice M. M. Punchhi); recommended localized emergency under Art 355, fixed 5-year tenure for Governors, and amending Art 356.
Santhanam Committee	**1962–64**	Committee on Prevention of Corruption; recommended statutory code of conduct (आचरण नियमावली) and creation of **Central Vigilance Commission (CVC, 1964)**.
Swaran Singh Committee	**1976**	Recommended incorporation of **Fundamental Duties**; 42nd Amendment Act 1976 inserted Part IVA and Article 51A.
Dinesh Goswami Committee	**1990**	Comprehensive electoral reforms; advocated electronic voting machines (EVMs), stringent anti-defection checks, and state assistance.
Indrajit Gupta Committee	**1998**	Recommended state funding of elections in kind (fuel, paper, airtime) to candidates of recognized parties.
Tarkunde Committee	**1974**	Electoral reforms; proposed lowering the voting age to 18 (adopted (अंगीकृत) via 61st Constitutional Amendment 1988).
Vohra Committee	**1993**	Examined the criminalization of politics and nexus between politicians, bureaucrats, and underworld syndicates.

2. Panchayati Raj Committees Chronology



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1977: Ashok Mehta Committee (2-tier system / Mandal Panchayat & Zila Parishad)
                                  |
1978: Dantwala Committee (Block-level planning)
                                  |
1985: G.V.K. Rao Committee (District planning / "Grass without roots")
                                  |
1986: L.M. Singhvi Committee (Constitutional status for Panchayats)
                                  |
1988: P.K. Thungon Committee (Constitutional status / 5-year fixed term)
                                  |
1988: V.N. Gadgil Committee (Basis for 73rd Amendment Bill)
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Committee	Year	Decisive Recommendation
Balwant Rai Mehta	**1957**	**3-tier system:** Gram Panchayat (village), Panchayat Samiti (block), Zila Parishad (district); National Development Council accepted report in 1958.
Ashok Mehta	**1977**	**2-tier system:** Zila Parishad at district, Mandal Panchayat for cluster of villages (15,000–20,000 pop); open party participation.
G. V. K. Rao	**1985**	Warned against bureaucratization of development ("grass without roots"); proposed DDC (District Development Commissioner).
L. M. Singhvi	**1986**	**Constitutional recognition, protection, and preservation of PRIs**; revival of Nyaya Panchayats.
P. K. Thungon	**1988**	Reaffirmed constitutional status, 5-year fixed tenure, and mandatory State Finance Commission (वित्त आयोग).

3. Social Justice, Education & Reservation Commissions

Commission / Committee	Year	Core Subject & Historical Impact
Kaka Kalelkar Commission	**1953**	**First Backward Classes Commission**; submitted report in 1955 identifying 2,399 backward castes; rejected by Union Government.
Mandal Commission	**1979**	**Second Backward Classes Commission** (B. P. Mandal); identified 3,743 castes (52% pop); recommended **27% reservation for OBCs** in Union jobs (implemented in 1990 by V. P. Singh govt).
Justice G. Rohini Commission	**2017**	Sub-categorization of OBCs to ensure equitable distribution of benefits among underrepresented OBC (अन्य पिछड़ा वर्ग) groups under Art 340.
Kothari Commission	**1964–66**	Landmark education commission (Dr. D. S. Kothari); suggested common school system, 10+2+3 structure, 6% GDP target.
Kasturirangan Committee	**2019**	Drafted National Education Policy (NEP 2020); 5+3+3+4 foundational to secondary learning stages.
Sachar Committee	**2005**	High-level committee on the social, educational, and economic conditions of Indian Muslims (Justice Rajindar Sachar).

Commission / Committee	Year	Core Subject & Historical Impact
Xaxa Committee	**2013**	Socio-economic, health, and land alienation conditions of Tribal (आदिवासी) communities (Prof. Virginius Xaxa).
M. S. Swaminathan Commission	**2004–06**	National Commission on Farmers; recommended fixing Minimum Support Price (MSP) at least 50% more than weighted average cost of production (C2 + 50%).